

Karthikeyan Baskaran

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Summary

Procurement & Supplier Engineering Professional with 7+ years of experience in NPI, technical sourcing, and capital equipment procurement across advanced manufacturing environments. Strong expertise in RFQ-to-PO execution, supplier qualification (APQP/PPAP), and engineering change management (ECO), ensuring seamless translation of design intent into production readiness. Experienced in DFM, drawing interpretation, and should-cost modeling to optimize supplier selection and cost performance. Proven ability to collaborate with Engineering and Manufacturing teams to support prototyping, tooling, and product launches. Skilled in SAP, SQL, Power BI, and automation tools to drive data-backed procurement and supplier performance visibility.

Skills

Technical Procurement & NPI: RFQ-to-PO, Project Purchasing, NPI Cycle, Supplier Selection, Tooling Procurement
Engineering & Design Integration: DFM, Drawing Interpretation, GD&T,; ECO Management, Technical Specifications, Engineering Alignment
Supplier Quality Engineering: APQP, PPAP, Supplier Audits, SCAR, RCA, Supplier Qualification
Manufacturing & Process Control: Yield Analysis, GR&R,; Lean Manufacturing, Six Sigma
Supplier Performance Management: On-Time Delivery, Lead Time Optimization, Scorecards, KPI Monitoring, Supplier Risk Management
Cost Engineering & Sourcing: Should Cost Analysis, Value Engineering, Spend Analysis, Cost Reduction, Benchmarking
Data Analytics & Automation: Power BI, SQL, Python, Excel, Dashboarding, Reporting Automation
ERP & Systems: SAP, MRP, Procure-to-Pay, Master Data Management, ERP Optimization
Cross Functional Leadership: Engineering Collaboration, Manufacturing Coordination, Stakeholder Management, Supplier Communication, Project Coordination

Work Experience

Procurement Buyer
Decibel Cannabis Company

Dec 2025 - Present

- Led end-to-end technical procurement for NPI and production materials, managing RFQ-to-PO lifecycle and ensuring alignment with Engineering Change Orders (ECO) for seamless product launch execution.
- Built SQL-driven supplier performance monitoring system to track lead time, quality, and delivery KPIs, improving early identification of supply risks impacting prototype and production readiness.
- Developed Power BI analytics framework consolidating ERP procurement and project purchasing data, improving RFQ turnaround time and supporting faster engineering-aligned sourcing decisions.
- Strengthened Procure-to-Pay execution within Sage ERP by implementing workflow standardization and data validation controls, achieving 99%+ data accuracy and improved material availability.
- Supported CAPEX and equipment procurement planning by aligning purchasing schedules with production forecasts and engineering demand signals, improving material readiness and reducing delays.
- Optimized supplier selection strategy through consolidation and risk diversification, improving on-time delivery performance by 30% and strengthening supplier reliability for critical components.
- Integrated procurement planning with manufacturing demand signals to balance inventory and working capital, reducing excess stock by 20% without impacting production continuity.
- Facilitated cross-functional alignment between Engineering, Manufacturing, and Procurement teams to support ECO execution and improve supplier coordination for NPI readiness.

Purchaser in Global Procurement
Vestas Wind Systems

Nov 2021 - Aug 2023

- Managed end-to-end technical sourcing of engineered components including electrical systems and assemblies, ensuring alignment with design intent through drawing interpretation and DFM collaboration.
- Conducted supplier qualification and NPI readiness assessments using APQP/PPAP principles, strengthening supplier capability for prototype-to-production transition.
- Supported tooling and prototype procurement activities by coordinating supplier onboarding, technical clarifications, and engineering validation for critical components.
- Delivered 15% cost reduction through should-cost modeling and structured supplier evaluation for capital equipment and high-value engineered parts.
- Improved supplier lead-time and quality performance by implementing KPI scorecards and Power BI dashboards tracking delivery reliability and defect trends.
- Performed structured supplier risk assessments and alternate sourcing analysis, reducing supply disruption exposure for critical wind turbine components.
- Automated RFQ comparison and procurement reporting using Python tools, reducing sourcing cycle time by 30–40% and improving engineering decision speed.
- Partnered with Engineering teams to translate technical specifications into supplier-ready documentation, improving drawing clarity interpretation and reducing rework.
- Enhanced SAP master data quality using validation scripts, improving material planning accuracy and reducing procurement errors by 25%.
- Applied Lean principles to procurement workflows to improve process efficiency, standardization, and sourcing cycle scalability.

Consultant ECM Purchaser in Global Procurement,Vestas
ManpowerGroup Services

Jan 2021 - Nov 2021

- Executed RFx and technical sourcing activities ensuring alignment with engineering specifications and project delivery timelines across multiple categories.
- Developed procurement automation tools for RFQ comparison and supplier evaluation, reducing sourcing cycle time and improving decision turnaround speed.
- Partnered with Engineering and Project teams to translate technical requirements into supplier-ready documentation, improving procurement accuracy and reducing rework.
- Built Power BI and Python dashboards for supplier performance tracking, improving visibility into delivery, cost, and quality KPIs for stakeholders.
- Implemented Lean-based procurement process improvements, increasing workflow efficiency by 20% and standardizing bid evaluation procedures.
- Strengthened supplier engagement and communication frameworks, improving vendor responsiveness and coordination across procurement cycles.
- Integrated SAP procurement workflows with reporting systems, reducing manual effort by 30% and improving data consistency.
- Supported global sourcing and logistics coordination, improving material delivery reliability and procurement execution efficiency.

Procurement Engineer(Intern) - Global Sourcing
Valeo India

Jan 2019 - Jan 2021

- Managed RFx and e-auction sourcing for automotive components, achieving 10–15% cost reduction through structured negotiation and engineering-aligned supplier evaluation.
- Conducted supplier benchmarking and dual-sourcing strategy development, improving supply chain resilience and reducing single-source dependency risks.
- Performed should-cost and zero-based costing analysis to support supplier negotiations and improve cost transparency for engineered components.
- Built automated KPI dashboards for supplier performance tracking, improving visibility of quality, delivery, and cost metrics across procurement categories.
- Executed supplier risk and compliance assessments, strengthening supply continuity and reducing disruption risk in critical automotive components.
- Standardized RFx templates and procurement workflows, improving governance and reducing sourcing cycle time by 20%.
- Optimized pricing structures through market benchmarking and cost analysis, improving sourcing decisions and procurement competitiveness.
- Implemented trade finance (TReDS) initiatives, improving supplier liquidity and strengthening supplier relationships across key categories.

Projects

SAP Procurement Automation
Automated procurement reporting and master-data update and validation within SAP using VBA and workflow automation, improving purchasing efficiency and data accuracy.
(SAP, ERP, Procurement, Process Improvement)

Supply Chain Risk Mitigation
Developed a sourcing-risk analysis solution that identified alternative suppliers, monitored supply disruptions, and improved procurement continuity planning.
(Supplier Risk, Procurement, Supply Continuity, Supply Chain)

Demand Gap Analysis & Inventory Optimization
Developed ERP-driven purchasing models to identify demand gaps, forecast shortages, and optimize inventory levels across critical material portfolios, improving supply continuity and inventory health.
(Demand Analysis, Inventory Planning, ERP, Supply Continuity)

Supplier Escalation Resolution Framework
Designed supplier performance scorecards and escalation workflows that improved issue resolution speed, supplier accountability, and on-time delivery performance.
(Supplier Escalations, Supplier Performance, KPI Tracking, Procurement)

Education

Post Grad Diploma in Data Analytics for Business
St. Clair College, Canada

GPA: 4.0 / 4.0
Sep 2023 - Apr 2025

Bachelor of Mechanical Engineering
St. Joseph's Institute of Technology, India

GPA: 3.7 / 4.0
Jun 2014 - Jun 2018